

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key



Hallucination Hunters — every planted error with the true fact, verdict guidance, fact-desk coaching, and the standards map.

WHY THIS LESSON

Every AI job runs **human** → **AI** → **human**: a person starts it (the prompt) and a person ends it (the check). This lesson trains the second human job. The core insight students leave with: AI predicts *likely* words, not *verified* words — so smoothness is zero evidence of truth. Lateral reading (leave the answer, confirm against a second, independent source) is the same move professional fact-checkers make, and it works on AI answers, group-chat rumors, and feeds alike.

RUNNING THE FACT DESK

Play the managing editor, not the answer key. When a desk asks "is this one true?", answer "that's a checkable claim — where's your second source?" Keep deadline energy: "Presses roll in five!"

Watch for the two failure modes. The trusting desk clears everything ("it sounded right") — send them back to step 1: did you underline the dates and names? The paranoid desk kills everything ("it's all sus") — that's what RANK is for: check what would hurt most. The goal is calibrated skepticism, not panic.

The fabricated quote in Draft #3 is the boss level. Many students treat quotation marks as proof. Desk rule: a quote is a claim — no traceable source, no print.

ANSWER KEY — WARM-UP PARAGRAPH (READ-ALoud)

PLANTED ERROR	THE TRUE FACT
"The closest planet to the Sun is Venus, which is also the hottest."	Mercury is closest to the Sun. Venus really is the hottest (its thick atmosphere traps heat) — the half-truth is what makes this one slippery.
"Saturn... is the only planet in our solar system that has [rings]."	Jupiter, Uranus, and Neptune also have rings — faint ones. Saturn's are just the most visible.

True claims a desk should mark SAFE or confirm: eight planets; Mars is red from rusty iron dust on its surface; sunlight takes about eight minutes to reach Earth.

ANSWER KEY — THE THREE DRAFTS (EVERY PLANTED ERROR)

DRAFT	PLANTED ERROR	THE TRUE FACT
#1 Priya	"Astronauts first landed on the Moon in 1959"	The first crewed Moon landing was Apollo 11, in 1969 .
#1 Priya	"the Moon... produces its own light"	The Moon makes no light of its own — it reflects sunlight .
#2 Theo	"Mount Everest... rises in the Andes range in South America"	Everest is in the Himalayas, in Asia . The Andes are in South America.
#2 Theo	"Australia's capital city is Sydney"	The capital is Canberra , not Sydney. A classic mix-up.
#3 Marcus	"Thomas Edison invented the telephone in 1876"	Alexander Graham Bell patented the telephone in 1876. Edison's fame: the phonograph and practical electric lighting.
#3 Marcus	Quote: "The telephone is the finest of all my inventions."	Fabricated — written for this exercise; it has no source. AI generates real-sounding quotes nobody said. No traceable source = no print.
#1 Priya	Conclusion: "the brightest thing in the night sky"	True claim, false reason. The Moon IS the brightest night-sky object — but because it reflects sunlight, not because it makes light. The argument breaks even though the ending is right. Verdict: FIX .
#2 Theo	Conclusion: "record-holders sit on three continents: Africa, South America, and Asia"	Once Everest moves back to Asia (the Himalayas), South America holds none of the passage's records, so the conclusion no longer follows. Verdict: FIX .
#3 Marcus	Conclusion: "the most important inventor of the 1800s"	An opinion propped up by a false fact (Edison did not invent the telephone) and an invented quote. Strip those and the claim is unsupported. Verdict: KILL the conclusion, keep the true phonograph and Wright brothers facts.

True claims, safe to confirm: #1 — the Moon is Earth's only natural satellite; Neil Armstrong walked first; twelve people have walked on the Moon. #2 — Pacific is the largest ocean; the Nile flows north through Egypt, one of the world's longest rivers; seven continents; Asia is the largest. #3 — the phonograph (1877) was the first machine to both record and play back sound; the Wright brothers flew in 1903 near Kitty Hawk, North Carolina.

Verdict guidance: Draft #1 — **FIX** (topic holds; correct the date and the light claim). Draft #2 — **FIX** (correct the range and the capital). Draft #3 — **KILL** (headline claim false, supporting quote fabricated — no story left to fix). No draft earns RUN today; tell the class that's realistic. A well-argued FIX on #3 ("rewrite it about Bell") earns credit for evidence — then ask: is that a fix, or a new story? Score the evidence, not the stamp: proficient desks name the claim, the correction, and a second source.

🔍 EXIT TICKET KEY

#1 — How can AI sound 100% sure and still be wrong? Full credit names the mechanism: AI predicts the *likely next words*; it doesn't check them against anything. Confidence is a writing style, not evidence. Accept "it guesses what sounds right" or "it's a smooth talker, not a fact-checker." Partial credit: "it makes mistakes" with no why.

#2 — A real claim + the lateral-reading move. Full credit names a checkable claim AND a specific second, independent source ("the NASA site, not the video that made the claim"; "the team's official schedule"; "two news outlets that don't copy each other"). Partial: "Google it" with no source named — push back: "Google shows you ten sources. Which one, and why that one?"

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS (DEBRIEF, OR THE NEXT DAY)

- Most of the room voted to print the warm-up paragraph. What made it *feel* true? (Smooth sentences, confident tone, real-sounding details.)
- Why is a fabricated quote more dangerous than a wrong date? (A date is easy to check; a quote borrows a real person's credibility.)
- Marcus's ending was an opinion built on a false fact. Can an opinion be "wrong"? (It can be unsupported — when the evidence under it fails, so does the argument.)
- Where in your week does a claim get to skip the fact desk? (Group chats, reposts, captions. The desk is a habit, not a job.)

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CCSS ELA RI.6.8** — Trace and evaluate the argument and specific claims in a text, distinguishing claims that are supported by reasons and evidence from claims that are not. *Taught: Fact-desk method steps 1 and 4 (underline claims; test the conclusion). Assessed: the RUN/FIX/KILL verdict + note on each draft.*
- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: lateral reading, step 3. Assessed: "Second source" columns + Exit Ticket #2.*
- **ISTE 1.3.d** — Students build knowledge by actively exploring real-world issues and problems, developing ideas and theories and pursuing answers and solutions. *Taught: The Fact Desk activity — desks pursue verification, defend verdicts in the stand-up. Assessed: Exit Ticket #2 (a real claim from their week) + stand-up evidence.*

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